



Winamp -> Plexamp

Plex has a new incubator division and Plexamp, a media player software is their first product.
<http://dgit.in/Plexamp>



Twitter's new anti-hate rules

Twitter to begin enforcing new rules to reduce hateful and abusive content on the platform.
<http://dgit.in/TwitrProtec>



Whine away

Agent001's PC has got a nasty case of coil whine and he's on a mission to fix it.

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aving recently moved my PC to another desk in the office, I was all set to start anew. A new desk

presents various new possibilities. I can, again, put my feet up on the desk or suffice with just one foot while the other one stays firmly grounded. I'm no fan of yoga or any physical activity, for that matter, but having one foot up in the air makes for a much more comfortable writing pose. The other aspect of moving is setting up my PC all over again. It's after having put together my entire system at my new desk that I came upon a rather irritating little thing – coil whine.

No, I haven't changed any hardware. The only difference is the position of the machine in the office. So the other new thing about the setup is the AC mains into which the system is plugged in. It would appear that the new power outlet isn't exactly wired right. Perhaps there is a heavy duty appliance drawing power from the same line causing this nasty disturbance. To make matters worse, the disturbance can screw with more of my hardware than just the power supply. Depending on the quality of the filter circuit within the power supply, one can expect a teensy bit of the interference to pass through. And that can wreak havoc on any of the remaining components. The CPU tends to be the

least affected since it has more levels of filtration between it and the 12 volt ATX line but for everything else, we're looking at a ticking time bomb.

If you're wondering what a coil whine is, then here's a little primer. Your AC power mains operates at 50 Hz and conducts 230 Volts. When you want to rectify that into DC power, you need really big capacitors and inductors for filtering. However, if

hear as coil whine or as it is properly known – electromagnetically excited acoustic noise and vibration.

Unfortunately, not much can be done for it. Certain power supply manufacturers have advised switching on the ErP/EuP option and switching off the onboard audio within the BIOS. That did not work in my case. So after a little more Googling, I came upon a novel solution. One that's destined to

void my warranty. Allow me to explain. Inductors and chokes within power supplies are known to vibrate, so some manufacturers apply generous amounts of dielectric goop onto the coils. Since there's is no way I can get my hands on some of that easily, I was forced to improvise. I took out one of the old power supplies from the Digit Test Centre and connected it to



Whiny li'l coil.

you were to switch the frequency to a higher value, then these components need not be huge, and the space saved allows for more compact designs. Flow of electric current through a conductor induces magnetism and that causes the component to move a little. Now if you consider a high frequency AC current flowing through the conductor, then it will start swaying at a high frequency. This vibration is what we

the same outlet and used the paperclip trick to turn it on. That did not have any coil whine. So I had to load the power supply with a couple of cooling fans and try again. Voila! Coil whine. Believe me, the irony of wanting coil whine was not lost on me.

Now I had two options, I could either use RTV Silicone on the components or hot glue. The former uses acetic acid which can be quite corro-